



HTTPS Everywhere

Paranoid about security? Use this "HTTPS Everywhere" to securely encrypt all your browsing data. <http://cnet.co/nZ0n0s>



Cold Comfort

PSKmail, a handy little Java application that will allow you to send email from anywhere, even the Arctic!. <http://pskmail.org>

Bazaar

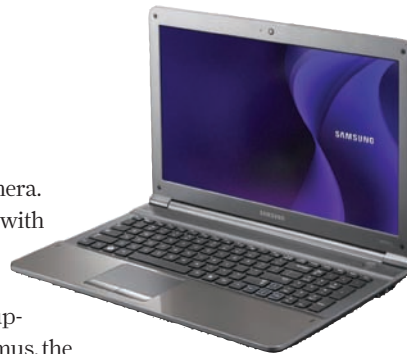
Samsung RC510

Simply stylish, good build quality

The RC510 is a reasonably slim 15.6-inch notebook with a stylish glossy finish in charcoal grey. The notebook feels well built. The glossy raised palmrest takes stress off ones wrists while getting slick if used with sweaty wrists. The keypad is an isolated type and while key spacing is decent, we found the keys a little small – the keypad is decent. There are no multimedia keys, although a dedicated number pad is provided. The trackpad material feels just right, while its accuracy is good, for precision work a mouse is required. 4 USB ports, an HDMI port and the usual card slot, optical drive and LAN port are mundane nowadays. The display is glossy while above it

perches a 1.3MP web camera.

The RC510 is blessed with a shiny new power plant – the Intel Core i3 380M, a dual core with HT support. With NVIDIA Optimus, the RC510 can switch between Intel HD graphics and its dedicated GeForce 315M GPU. This isn't a potent gaming system by any stretch, and will strictly play older games sans framing. It barely managed 24.17 fps in Far Cry 2 at medium setting and a resolution of 1024 x 768 pixels. A GT540M manages over 60 fps at the same settings. The storage system consists of a 500GB HDD, and not a fast one at that. With just 20 and 25MB/s in the non-sequential and sequential transfers respectively. Playback of 1080p content is



seamless, and the display while plagued with poor viewing angles has a nice saturated look that gives colour in videos a little more "pop".

From the perspective of someone looking at a desktop replacement, the RC510 performs reasonably well and will easily run more mundane applications, but it is not a performance machine, nor would be expect it to be at a price of ₹39,990. For anyone looking at something to browse on, do a lot of office work as well as play the odd game, the RC510 will deliver.

Michael Browne

Specifications

Specifications: Core i3 380M (2.53 GHz); **RAM:** 3 GB 1066 MHz; **GPU:** NVIDIA GT315M/ Intel HD 3000 graphics; **HDD:** 500 GB, 5,400 rpm; 2.5 kgs

Contact

Samsung India Electronics Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: 0124-4881234

Web site: www.samsung.com/in

Email: ravigulati@samsung.com

Price: ₹39,990

6.5/10

Features.....6.5
Performance.....6.5
Build Quality7.5
Value for Money6.5

Zebronics ZEB-Station

Tune in without breaking the bank

Specifications

Speakers: 2, no subwoofer;

Power output: 15 x 2 watts RMS

Contact

Top Notch Infotronics India Pvt.

Phone: 044-4000-0007

Web site: www.zebronics.net

Email: enquiry@zebronics.info

Price: ₹1,650

7.0/10

Features.....7.0
Performance.....5.0
Build Quality7.5
Value for Money8.5

The ZEB-Station is meant to be a speaker cum dock for all types of audio interfaces. This simple looking, but well built box houses two 15-watt speakers. The mock dark mahogany finish is nice, but the large cheap-feeling volume knob is not. The front panel has a plethora of buttons for changing input source and multimedia functions. These are small, hard to press and feel clicky. The volume knob also changes sources as well as serves as the tuner for FM Radio. And while on topic, the Station supports FM Radio, RCA input, SD/MMC cards and USB connects. It lacks a proprietary Apple iPod port.

The ZEB-Station betrays its basic nature by not including a track information display when playing via memory card. All you'll see is track 1. The inclusion of a fully featured remote unit is a plus, it lets you access more functions like changing treble, bass, and selecting a track. The remote operates well from a distance of 6-7 feet although you'll want to sit closer to enjoy the music. There is no auxiliary out, the ZEB-Station relies on its own small speakers.

The volume level isn't much, so no worries about bringing the house down. We found the bass lacking, but this was expected. However, the mid-range is pretty decent, and some vocals sound nice, as do accompanying instruments. The treble is rolled off, but not too harsh. Finer nuances of sound get missed, but the mid-range maintains its sweetness.

When one talks music quality and uses phrases like audiophile, the little ZEB-Station cannot keep up. But that becomes irrelevant when you read the price tag – a mere ₹1,650. Its value for money quotient cannot be denied. The ZEB-Station is sure to be a little cash that's well spent.

Michael Browne

